Reconnaissance and Footprinting Lab Report

Target Organization: Home Depot, Inc.

Course: CIS4204 Ethical Hacking
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Introduction

In this lab I selected The Home Depot (homedepot.com) as my target and carried out the footprinting and reconnaissance techniques described in Chapter 2. All the information listed below was obtained from publicly available sources, using search engines, carrying out WHOIS/DNS lookups, checking the company's SEC filings, and referring to Home Depot's own robots.txt file. I did not carry out any active scans or directly connect to any of their systems, merely performing passive lookups that anyone can make using a browser or from the command line.

1. nslookup of homedepot.com

I ran this from Command Prompt on my own machine:

```
nslookup homedepot.com
```

Here's what came back:

```
Server:  SAX2V1S.lan
Address:  192.168.1.1

Non-authoritative answer:
Name:    homedepot.com
Address:  35.201.95.83
```

The first block (Server/Address) is just my own router answering the query — that's not Home Depot's info. The actual IP address for homedepot.com is 35.201.95.83.

2. WHOIS lookup on 35.201.95.83 (via ARIN)

I took that IP and ran it through ARIN's WHOIS tool (whois.arin.net):

```
NetRange:     35.192.0.0 - 35.207.255.255
CIDR:         35.192.0.0/12
NetName:      GOOGLE-CLOUD
NetType:      Direct Allocation
Organization: Google LLC (GOOGL-2)
Address:      1600 Amphitheatre Parkway, Mountain View, CA 94043
RegDate:      2006-09-29 (org) / 2017-03-21 (netblock)
Abuse:        https://support.google.com/code/go/gce_abuse_report
```

What surprised me in this case is that the IP address isn't registered to Home Depot at all; it's registered to Google LLC. Home Depot's website therefore uses Google Cloud for hosting, and as a result a simple WHOIS query will only reveal who is hosting the site, not who owns it.

3. Same lookup using research.domaintools.com

I ran the same IP (35.201.95.83) through research.domaintools.com to compare:

```
IP Location:   Kansas City, United States
ASN:           AS396982 GOOGLE-CLOUD-PLATFORM - Google LLC, US
               (registered Aug 15, 2018)
Resolve Host:  83.95.201.35.bc.googleusercontent.com
Whois Server:  whois.arin.net
Reverse IP:    123 other websites use this address

(Underlying Whois record matches ARIN: NetRange 35.192.0.0 -
35.207.255.255,
 Organization: Google LLC)
```

4. Compare the results from Questions 2 and 3

The basic registration details – the net range, the CIDR, and the organization name (Google LLC) were identical in the two cases, which is reasonable because DomainTools is drawing its information from the same ARIN registry data underneath.

DomainTools did give me a few extra things ARIN's plain lookup didn't:

- *Roughly where the IP is located (Kansas City, US)*
- *The ASN and when it was registered (AS396982, registered 8/15/2018)*
- *A reverse DNS hostname that also points back to Google*
- *It also told me 123 other websites share this exact same IP, so it's a shared cloud address, not something set aside just for Home Depot*

In effect, DomainTools is adding extra geo-IP and passive-DNS information to the same basic WHOIS record, which provided me with more data than a simple ARIN lookup would have done.

5. Google search of the URL homedepot.com — first five links

For this one I just typed "homedepot.com" straight into Google, no operators.

First five results I got:

1. https://careers.homedepot.com/
2. https://www.linkedin.com/jobs/the-home-depot-jobs-tampa-fl
3. https://www.indeed.com/q-home-depot-jobs-l-tampa,-fl-jobs.html
4. https://www.homedepot.com/path-to-pro-network
5. https://www.homedepot.com/path-to-pro-network

What drew my attention was the fact that nearly all of these are job advertisements, including those from Home Depot's own careers page as well as the listings on LinkedIn and Indeed, rather than coming from the actual store website. I think that Google produced these results in this way because I've been job searching due to graduation coming up and the fact they used my current location. This also ties in with the example of job postings that I discussed earlier in the chapter (Figure 2.8). Companies end up revealing a surprising amount of information through their own job ads and wherever those ads end up being indexed.

6. Google dork: filetype:pdf pdf site:homedepot.com

I searched: filetype:pdf pdf site:homedepot.com

Some of the PDFs that came back:

• corporate.homedepot.com — 2025 "Living Our Values" corporate culture report

• ir.homedepot.com — FY2023 Form 10-K

• ir.homedepot.com — Q1 2026 earnings call transcript

• ir.homedepot.com — FY2025 Form 10-K (most recent)

• homedepot.com/catalog/pdfImages/... — a few product catalog image PDFs

• ir.homedepot.com — 2026 Proxy Statement

• ir.homedepot.com — an older investor presentation (Carol Tomé, former CFO)

The majority of these documents are investor relations in nature, and the proxy statement is most useful when it comes to recon since it includes the board members, executive salaries, and ownership stakes, all of which are public but still provide useful background information. I didn't notice anything that seemed to be an accidental leak; all of the information presented here was something that Home Depot published intentionally.

7. Google search using another directive from the chapter

I went with: intitle:"index of" site:homedepot.com

```
No results found for intitle:"index of" site:homedepot.com.
```

That in fact is a positive point for Home Depot since it shows that Google has not indexed any of the open directory listings on their website. Perhaps they don't have any servers that are misconfigured and thus exposing raw file directories, or if they do have such servers, then the directories are not accessible to public crawlers. In any case, there is nothing worth mentioning here other than the lack of that specific kind of exposure.

8. Financial reporting site — latest 10-K, corporate phone number and address

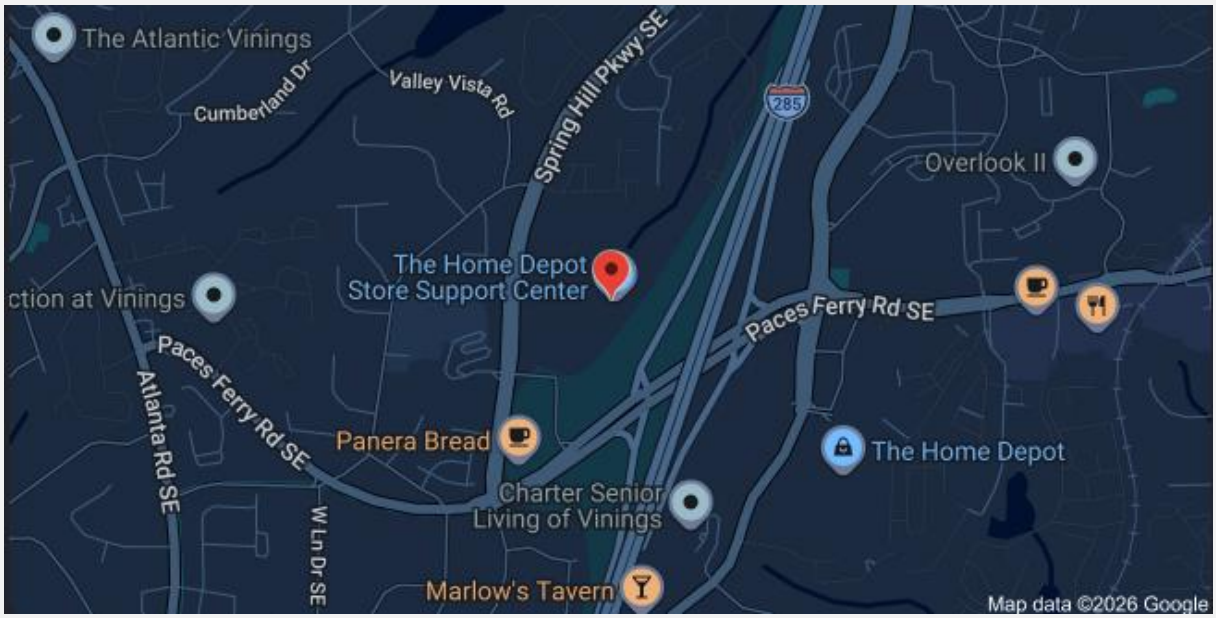
I pulled up Home Depot's most recent Form 10-K (fiscal year ended February 1, 2026), and right on the cover page it lists:

Corporate Address: 2455 Paces Ferry Road, Atlanta, Georgia 30339

Telephone: (770) 433-8211

9. Google Maps — corporate address

I looked up that same address on Google Maps to see the actual building (Home Depot's Store Support Center):



10. Executive team (insider roster)

Pulled from Home Depot's investor relations site and their FY2025 10-K, the current execs are:

• Edward P. "Ted" Decker — Chair, President & Chief Executive Officer (currently on a temporary medical leave of absence as of August 2026)

• Richard V. McPhail — Executive Vice President & Chief Financial Officer

• Ann-Marie Campbell — Senior Executive Vice President

• Angela "Angie" Brown — Executive Vice President & Chief Information Officer

• Franziska "Fran" Bell — Executive Vice President & Chief Technology Officer

11. One executive's previous place of employment

I picked Richard McPhail (the CFO) and investigated his background. Before joining Home Depot in 2005, he was:

• Executive Vice President of Corporate Finance at Marconi Corporation, plc (England)

• Before that, he held positions at Wachovia Securities and Arthur Andersen

12. robots.txt from homedepot.com

```
User-agent: *
Disallow: /*SiteMapView*
Disallow: /*Navigation?Ns=P_Topseller_Sort|style=List*
Disallow: /*Navigation?Ns=P_Topseller_Sort|style=A*
Disallow: /*CheckoutSignIn*
Disallow: /*OrderItemUpdate*
Disallow: /*THDLogon*
Disallow: /*ShippingMethod*
Disallow: /*OrderItemDisplayViewShiptoAssoc*
Disallow: /*DeliveryCalendar*
Disallow: /*OrderItemAdd*
Disallow: /*MoreViewsPage*
Disallow: /*Search?*
Disallow: /*NCNI-5*
Disallow: /*recordCompareList*
Disallow: /*PLP_Overlay*
Disallow: /*Ntt-*
Disallow: /*Ntk-*
Disallow: /*AjaxNavigation*
Disallow: /*Fragments/
Disallow: /s/
Disallow: /p/qv/
Disallow: /*OnlineAccount*
Disallow: /*mycart*
Disallow: /*mycheckout*
Disallow: /*usebeta*
Disallow: /canvas/
Disallow: /pep/
Disallow: /auth/view/signin?redirect=*
Disallow: /auth/view/createaccount?redirect=*
Disallow: /clickstream-producer/v1/publish
Disallow: /l/search/*
Disallow: /l/detail/*
Disallow: /b/Featured-Products*
Disallow: /compare?*
Disallow: /schedule-a-measure/
Disallow: /services/*/reviews/page/*
Allow: /services/*/reviews/page/1$
Disallow: /e/
Disallow: /custom-blinds/Configurator*
Disallow: /cart$
Disallow: /cart/
```

```
Disallow: /cart*
Disallow: /checkout*
Disallow: /order-confirmation*
Disallow: /customer/account/v1/citi/renderFormParameters
Allow: /s/*?CI-5
Disallow: /list/view/details/*

Sitemap: https://www.homedepot.com/sitemap/main.xml
```

A few of the disallowed paths stood out to me. Things like THDLogon, OnlineAccount, mycart/mycheckout, and internal-sounding folders like canvas/ and pep/. It also points straight to their XML sitemap, which is basically a map of every category of page on the whole site.

Summary

This experiment demonstrated the amount of information you can obtain about a company without in any way accessing its actual systems. By using search engines, carrying out WHOIS lookups, examining SEC filings, and looking at one text file, I was able to discover their hosting provider, their true corporate address, the current leadership team, and one executive's career history prior to their time at Home Depot, all from data that was intended to be publicly available from the beginning.